



Central heating

To survive the freezing cold of the Ice age, the Neanderthals used fire to keep their homes warm. They wore clothes made of animal skin and fur, much like Arctic people do today. They may even have lined their beds with rabbit fur to keep themselves snug at night.

A heavy brow ridge gave Neanderthals a glowering expression.

Numerous chips and scratches suggest the teeth were used as tools.

Tool kit

Like *Homo erectus*, the Neanderthals made stone tools by chipping flakes off a rock to form a sharp edge. Their tools were much more varied than those of *Homo erectus* and included heavy-duty hand axes; smaller, more delicate knives; and spearheads. Neanderthals probably also made tools from wood that have not survived.



The Neanderthal voicebox was just like ours, which means Neanderthals could probably speak.

Clues from bones

Scientists have found the remains of around 275 Neanderthals. Wear marks and injuries on the bones reveal that their owners endured great physical stress and often violence. The injuries match those of rodeo riders—perhaps Neanderthals wrestled with the animals they hunted. Some Neanderthal bones bear scratches made by stone tools. Some experts think this means Neanderthals were cannibals. Others think the dead were “defleshed” in religious ceremonies before burial.

Large skull housed a bigger brain



Six feet under

Neanderthal skeletons have been found in what appear to be graves, suggesting that Neanderthals deliberately buried their dead. Unlike later humans, however, they seldom placed sacred or precious objects with the bodies.

